



RCCG OCEANIA

Relationships

BUILDING INTIMACY IN MARRIAGE

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Discover how intimacy acts as the cornerstone of a resilient marriage. Through biblical insights and practical steps, learn to build a relationship that can withstand life's challenges. Explore the importance of trust, intentionality, and understanding in nurturing a strong marital bond.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Genesis 2:23-24

Matthew 7:24-27

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Intimacy is the core strength of a marriage.
- A strong foundation in marriage is essential for resilience.
- Trust and transparency are crucial for intimacy.
- Intentional practices can enhance marital intimacy.
- Understanding and meeting your partner's needs fosters closeness.

INTRODUCTION

Marriage is a sacred bond that thrives on intimacy. This study explores how intimacy serves as the bedrock of a resilient marriage, drawing insights from Scripture to guide couples in building a strong, enduring relationship.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **Genesis 2:23-24** — Highlights the original unity and mission of marriage to become one.
- **Matthew 7:24-27** — Illustrates the importance of building a strong foundation in marriage.

KEY POINTS

1. **THE STRENGTH OF INTIMACY** — Intimacy is crucial for a strong marriage, providing the resilience needed to face challenges. It is the core that holds the relationship together. Without intimacy, couples may struggle to connect deeply and support each other through life's ups and downs. Intimacy involves emotional, physical, and spiritual closeness, which fosters a sense of unity and partnership.
 - Reflect on the current level of intimacy in your marriage.
 - Identify areas where intimacy can be strengthened.
 - Commit to regular, open communication with your spouse.

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

2. **BUILDING A STRONG FOUNDATION** — A marriage with a strong foundation can withstand various challenges. Like the parable of the two houses, a solid base is essential. Building this foundation involves aligning your marriage with biblical principles and ensuring that both partners are committed to the relationship's growth and stability.

- Evaluate the foundation of your marriage.
- Discuss with your spouse ways to strengthen your marital foundation.
- Implement practices that reinforce your commitment to each other.

Scripture: Matthew 7:24-27

3. **TRUST AND TRANSPARENCY** — Trust is essential for intimacy. Without it, the relationship cannot thrive. Transparency and integrity build this trust. Being honest and open with your spouse creates a safe environment where both partners feel valued and understood.

- Assess the level of trust in your marriage.
- Practice honesty and transparency in all interactions.
- Address any trust issues with patience and understanding.

4. **INTENTIONAL PRACTICES** — Being intentional about building intimacy involves understanding and meeting your partner's needs, managing emotions, and spending quality time together. These practices require effort and dedication but are vital for nurturing a close and fulfilling relationship.

- Schedule regular quality time with your spouse.
- Learn and respond to your partner's love language.
- Be proactive in addressing emotional needs and conflicts.

Scripture: Genesis 2:23-24

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What does Genesis 2:23-24 reveal about the purpose of marriage?
- How does Matthew 7:24-27 relate to building a strong marriage?
- What are some signs of a strong foundation in a marriage?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is intimacy considered the core strength of a marriage?
- How does trust influence the level of intimacy in a relationship?
- What role does intentionality play in enhancing marital intimacy?

APPLICATION

- What steps can you take to strengthen intimacy in your marriage?
- How can you build a stronger foundation in your relationship?
- In what ways can you improve trust and transparency with your spouse?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for a deepening of intimacy and understanding in marriages.
- Ask for wisdom to build a strong, biblical foundation in relationships.
- Seek God's guidance in fostering trust and transparency with your spouse.

NEXT STEP

Reflect on your current level of intimacy and take intentional steps to strengthen your marital bond.

CONCLUSION

Building intimacy in marriage is a continuous journey that requires dedication and intentionality. By grounding your relationship in biblical principles and fostering trust, transparency, and understanding, you can create a resilient and fulfilling marriage that stands the test of time.